

Lennart Schürmann | Dr.

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Research profile

I am a comparative political scientist specializing in political behavior, mobilization, and the political implications of societal transformation. My research explores how citizens mobilize beyond elections – through street, legal, and digital activism – and how institutional political actors respond.

Academic positions

Current

- | | |
|---|---|
| European University Institute Department of Political and Social Sciences
<i>Max Weber Fellow</i> <ul style="list-style-type: none">Mentor: <i>Simon Hix</i> | Florence (IT)
<i>Since Sep 2025</i> |
| Freie Universität Berlin Chair for Political Sociology
<i>Independent Post-Doctoral Researcher DAAD PRIME Fellow</i> <ul style="list-style-type: none">Hosted by: <i>Swen Hutter</i> | Berlin (DE)
<i>Since Jul 2025</i> |
| WZB Berlin Social Science Center Center for Civil Society Research
<i>Post-Doctoral Research Fellow</i> <ul style="list-style-type: none">Principal Investigator of the Project: ‘Empowering Voices Beyond Ballots’Involved in the Project: ‘Political Protest and Radicalization (MOTRA/ProtestMonitoring)’ | Berlin (DE)
<i>Since Jan 2023</i> |

Previous

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|---|---|
| Harvard University Minda de Gunzburg Center for European Studies
<i>Post-Doctoral Fellow Visiting Scholars Program hosted by Daniel Ziblatt</i> | Cambridge (US)
<i>Jan - Jun 2025</i> |
| University of Cologne Cologne Center for Comparative Politics
<i>Doctoral Researcher</i> <ul style="list-style-type: none">Conducted an Independently Funded PhD Project Full Scholarship, <i>Cologne Graduate School</i>Member of the Chair for European and Multilevel Politics (<i>Sven-Oliver Proksch</i>) | Cologne (DE)
<i>Oct 2019 – Dec 2022</i> |
| Pompeu Fabra University Institutions and Political Actors Research Group
<i>Visiting Researcher with Toni Rodon</i> | Barcelona (ES)
<i>Oct - Nov 2022</i> |
| WZB Berlin Social Science Center Center for Civil Society Research
<i>Guest Researcher with Swen Hutter</i> | Berlin (DE)
<i>Jun - Jul 2022</i> |
| University of Amsterdam Challenges to Democratic Representation Programme Group
<i>Visiting Researcher with Gijs Schumacher</i> | Amsterdam (NL)
<i>Sep - Dec 2021</i> |

Education

- | | |
|---|---|
| University of Cologne
Dr. rer. pol. (PhD) in Political Science <ul style="list-style-type: none">Title: Political Representation and Protest Politics in European DemocraciesSupervisors: Sven-Oliver Proksch & Ingo RohlfingDate of Defense: June 28th, 2023 | Cologne (DE)
<i>2019 – 2023</i> |
| Goethe University Frankfurt
M.A. in Political Science <ul style="list-style-type: none">Semester Abroad: EHESS School for Advanced Studies in the Social Sciences Paris | Frankfurt (DE) Paris (FR)
<i>2016 – 2019</i> |
| University of Cologne
B.Sc. in Social Sciences (Political Science, Sociology and Economics) <ul style="list-style-type: none">Semester Abroad: Grenoble Alpes University Sciences Po Grenoble | Cologne (DE) Grenoble (FR)
<i>2013 – 2016</i> |

Publications

Journal articles (peer reviewed).....

- [1] Saldivia Gonzatti, Daniel, **Lennart Schürmann**, Sophia Hunger & Swen Hutter (2026). [How Confrontational Protest Shapes Public Opinion: Experimental Evidence from Climate Mobilization](#). *Political Behavior*.
- [2] **Schürmann, Lennart** & Leonard Schmidt (2026). [Street Mobilization during Election Campaigns in Multilevel Systems: A Supply-Demand Analysis](#). *West European Politics*.
- [3] **Schürmann, Lennart**, Endre Borbáth, & Swen Hutter (2025). [Protest and the rise of left-nationalist challengers: evidence from Germany](#). *Social Movement Studies*.
- [4] **Schürmann, Lennart**, Jan Schwalbach, & Noam Himmelrath (2025). [Location matters! Geospatial dynamics of MP responses to Covid-19 protests in multilevel systems](#). *European Journal of Political Research*, 64(2): 513 - 534.
- [5] **Schürmann, Lennart** (2024). [The impact of local protests on political elite communication: evidence from Fridays for Future in Germany](#). *Journal of Elections, Public Opinion and Parties*, 34(3): 510 - 530.
- [6] Castanho Silva, Bruno, **Lennart Schürmann** & Sven-Oliver Proksch (2024). [Modulation of Democracy: Partisan Communication during and after Election Campaigns](#). *British Journal of Political Science*, 54(2): 339 - 354.
- [7] **Schürmann, Lennart** (2023). [Do competitive districts get more political attention? Strategic use of geographic representation during campaign and non-campaign periods](#). *Electoral Studies* 81, Article 102575.
- [8] **Schürmann, Lennart** & Sebastian Stier (2023). [Who represents the constituency? Online political communication by members of parliament in the German mixed-member electoral system](#). *Legislative Studies Quarterly*, 48(1): 219–234.

Contributions to edited volumes.....

- [1] **Schürmann, Lennart** & Swen Hutter (2026). [Ist Kartoffelbrei auf Kunst weniger akzeptiert als politische Gewalt? Wie die Menschen in Deutschland die Legitimität und Effektivität von Protest einschätzen](#). In: *Extremistische Einstellungen in Deutschland: Verbreitungen, Einflussfaktoren und Trends*, eds. Rebecca Endtricht. Wiesbaden: Springer VS.
- [2] Basu, Chitralkha & **Lennart Schürmann** (2025). [Media Effects on Political Elites](#). In: *Edward Elgar Encyclopedia of Political Communication*, eds. Alessandro Nai, Max Grömping & Dominique Wirz. Cheltenham: Edward Elgar Publishing.
- [3] Kanol, Eylem, Teresa Völker, Daniel Saldivia Gonzatti, **Lennart Schürmann** & Swen Hutter (2025). [Politischer Protest und Radikalisierung: Befunde aus dem WZB ProtestMonitoring](#). In: *MOTRA-Monitor 2023/24*. Wiesbaden: Bundeskriminalamt - Forschungsstelle Terrorismus/Extremismus, pp. 154-185.
- [4] Hutter, Swen, Eylem Kanol, Daniel Saldivia Gonzatti, **Lennart Schürmann**, Teresa Völker & Ruud Koopmans (2023). [Politischer Protest und Radikalisierung \(WZB-ProtestMonitoring\)](#). In: *MOTRA-Monitor 2022*. Wiesbaden: Bundeskriminalamt - Forschungsstelle Terrorismus/Extremismus, pp. 111-135.
 - shortened version re-published as [Der "heisse Herbst" war eher heisse Luft](#) in KATAPULT-Magazin 33/2024.

Blog entries & other publications.....

- [1] Stephan, Meret & **Lennart Schürmann** (2025). [Wirkungsvolle Proteste: Wie antirassistische Demonstrationen Wahlen beeinflussen](#). *WZB Mitteilungen*, 188: 10-12.
- [2] Saldivia Gonzatti, Daniel, **Lennart Schürmann** (2024). [Klima- und Umweltproteste in Deutschland von 1950 bis heute](#). *Klimawende Ausblick 2024. Gesellschaftliche Treiber der Transformation in Deutschland* Band 1. Klimapolitik, Klimabewegung und Klimaklagen. Universität Hamburg, pp. 76-78.
- [3] **Lennart Schürmann** (2023). [Von der Straße in den Bundestag: Die lokalen Proteste von Fridays for Future zeigen starke Wirkung](#). *WZB Mitteilungen*, 182: 6-9.
- [4] Schmidt, Leonhard, Carina Siebler, **Lennart Schürmann** & Daniel Saldivia Gonzatti (2023). [Fünf Jahre Fridays for Future - Erfolge, Herausforderungen und Chancen zur Erneuerung](#) *Blog: DVPW - Deutsche Vereinigung für Politikwissenschaft*.
- [5] Siebler, Carina, Leonhard Schmidt, **Lennart Schürmann** & Daniel Saldivia Gonzatti (2023). [Five years of 'Fridays for Future': but what future is there now for the movement?](#) *The Loop. A Political Science Blog from ECPR*.
 - re-published as [Five years of 'Fridays for Future': what future now?](#) on *Social Europe*.
- [6] **Schürmann, Lennart**, Caroline Melches, & Stefan Herweg (2019). [Minimalkompromisse machen die Eurozone nicht krisenfest](#). *Makronom – Online-Magazin für Wirtschaftspolitik*.

Working papers.....

- [1] Stephan, Meret & **Lennart Schürmann**. Conditional Allies: Party Positioning and the Electoral Power of Anti-Racist Street Mobilization
 - Preprint available as [WZB Discussion Paper ZZ 2025\(601\)](#).
- [2] **Schürmann, Lennart** & Teresa Völker. Defending Democracy: The Impact of State Action on Public Support for Democracy
- [3] **Schürmann, Lennart**. When Parties Go to Court: Opposition Legal Mobilization and Democratic Trust

Media engagement & public outreach

Background interviews and expert opinions for Tagesschau (ARD), Frankfurter Allgemeine Zeitung, DIE ZEIT, Quarks (WDR), nd.Aktuell (Neues Deutschland), ntv (RTL), goin' green (Seven.One), Green European Journal, Kölner Universitätsmagazin, taz-die tageszeitung, Frankfurter Rundschau & Bayerischer Rundfunk.

Speaker at public events organized by Brandenburgische Landeszentrale für politische Bildung, ZEIT-Stiftung Bucerius, Deutschlandfunk & ZEIT Campus.

Podcast appearances in Wissen unplugged/Hörsaal (Deutschlandfunk Nova), Was ist da los? Über Politik und Gesellschaft (Landeszentrale für politische Bildung Brandenburg), Quarks Daily – Dein täglicher Wissenspodcast (WDR), Wissen Weekly (Spotify Original).

Policy counseling for [Members of the German Parliament \(Leibniz im Bundestag\)](#).

Grants, fellowships & awards

Major grants & fellowships

Empowering Voices Beyond Ballots? Representative Claims by Non-Elected Political Actors

Funding: German Academic Exchange Service (DAAD PRIME Grant, 158.227,41 €)

2025 - 2026

Role: Principal Investigator (Sole Applicant)

Max Weber Fellowship

European University Institute | Social and Political Science Department

2025 - 2026

WZB Harvard Merit Fellowship

Harvard University | Minda de Gunzburg Center for European Studies, 41,172\$

2025

Smaller grants & scholarships

Citizens' Receptivity to Representative Claims by Non-Elected Political Actors:

A Multimodal Survey Experiment (EUI Early Stage Researcher Grant)

European University Institute, 2,070€

2026

IHS Hayek Fund Grant for Conference Travel Support

Institute for Humane Studies at George Mason University, 1,825\$ · 1,500\$ · 2,000\$

2025 | 2026 (2x)

Professional Development Award

FAS Office for Postdoctoral Affairs at Harvard University, 500\$

2025

Conference Travel Grants

DAAD German Academic Exchange Service, 836€ · 1776€

2025 | 2026

Full PhD Scholarship

Cologne Graduate School in Management, Economics and Social Sciences, ~55,000€

2019 - 2022

Selten Grant for Field Work and Research Stay in Barcelona

Reinhard Selten Institute/Cluster of Excellence ECONtribute: Markets and Public Policy, ~2,000€

2022

International Mobility Grant

Schmittmann-Wahlen-Foundation, ~5,500€

2015 | 2018 | 2021

Short-Term Research Grant for Doctoral Candidates for Research Stay in Amsterdam

DAAD German Academic Exchange Service, ~6,500€

2021

Grants for GESIS Spring Seminar & GESIS Workshop

University of Cologne & GESIS - Leibniz Institute for the Social Sciences

2021 (2x)

Residential Fellow

Fondation de l'Allemagne – Maison Heinrich Heine (Paris)

2018

Grant for ECPR Summer School in Methods and Techniques 2018

European Consortium for Political Research

2018

Erasmus Grants for Exchange Semesters

Erasmus+ Programme

2015 | 2018

Awards/recognition

Shortlisted (Top 3) for Assistant Professor position in Comparative Politics/Political Behavior

Challenges to Democratic Representation Group, Political Science Department, University of Amsterdam

2025

Shortlisted (Top 3) for Tenure-Track Professor position in Computational Social Sciences

C³S Center for Critical Computational Studies, Goethe University Frankfurt

2025

Finalist (Top 3) for University Teaching Award 2022

University of Cologne

2022

Teaching Experience

Causes and Consequences of Political Protest:

Lessons from Environmental and Climate Mobilization in Europe College of Europe – Natolin Campus (PL)
Visiting Professor | Overall assessment: 4.8 (max = 5) Spring 2026

Environmental Protests

Guest Lecturer University of Westminster (UK)
Spring 2026

EU Enlargement: Institutional Rationale and Citizens' Perspectives

Guest Lecturer University of Westminster (UK)
Spring 2026

Visualizing Protest Data in the Digital Space and Beyond

Coordinating WZB Project Partner in ViSoP Visual Society Program UdK Berlin University of the Arts (DE)
Spring 2023 – Spring 2024

Workshop: Applying for PhD Positions and Proposal Writing

Organizer together with Rebecca Kittel WZB Berlin Social Science Center (DE)
Fall 2023

- Participants successfully placed in PhD programs at CEU, FU Berlin, EUI & LSE

How Can Protest Change Politics?

Social Movements and Political Representation

Instructor | Overall assessment: 4.8 (max = 5) University of Cologne (DE)
Spring 2022

- Finalist (Top 3) for *University Teaching Award 2022* of the University of Cologne

Workshop: Creating a Webpage with R

Organizer together with J. Bekmuratovna University of Cologne (DE)
Spring 2022

Workshop: Authoring a PhD

Organizer together with Ebru Ece Özbey University of Cologne (DE)
Spring 2021

Strategic Models of Democratic Politics

Teaching Assistant to Chitralekha Basu University of Cologne (DE)
Fall 2020

Introduction to Quantitative Methods

Teaching Assistant to Bruno Castanho Silva University of Cologne (DE)
Fall 2019 | Fall 2020

Applied Statistical Analysis: Representation by Parliamentary Elites

Teaching Assistant to Dominic Nyhuis Goethe University Frankfurt (DE)
Spring 2017

Introduction to Statistics for Social Scientists

Teaching Assistant to Marita Jacob University of Cologne (DE)
Spring 2014 | Fall 2014 | Spring 2015

Certificates.....

Max Weber Programme Teaching Certificate

Structured pedagogical training programme European University Institute
2025–2026

Supervision & mentorship roles

Master's and Bachelor's theses.....

- Marie Melchers (2024). Electoral Success of Right-Wing Populists: A Threat to Liberal Democracy? *BA Thesis (University of Münster)*
- Meret Stephan (2024). Echoes of the Street: How do Pro-Migration Protests Influence Public Voting Behavior and Attitudes Regarding Migration? *MA Thesis (Humboldt University Berlin)*
- Aurelia von Haugwitz (2022). Why People from the German Countryside do not Protest: Urban-rural Divergences of 'Unconventional' Political Participation. *BA Thesis (University of Cologne)*

PhD mentees.....

- Charlotte Grupp (since 2025) | Social and Political Science Department (*European University Institute*)
- Stefanie Oelker (since 2025) | Dynamics of Social Inequalities Department (*WZB Social Science Center*)

Student assistants.....

- One research intern in *Monitoring- and Transferplatform Radicalisation* project (*WZB Social Science Center*)
- Eight research assistants for coding the WZB ProtestMonitoring datasets (*WZB Social Science Center*)

Research presentations

Invited talks.....

Forum Offene Wissenschaft: Krise der Weltordnung(en)?, Bielefeld University	2026
Challenges to Democratic Representation Programme Group Job Talk, University of Amsterdam	2025
C ³ S Center for Critical Computational Studies Job Talk, Goethe University Frankfurt	2025
New Research on Europe Seminar, Minda de Gunzburg Center for European Studies, Harvard University	2025
Institutions and Political Actors Research Seminar, Pompeu Fabra University Barcelona	2022
Hot Politics Lab Meeting, University of Amsterdam	2021

Conferences.....

*ASA American Sociological Association, New York City	2026
*APSA American Political Science Association, Boston	2026
*EPSS European Political Science Society, Belfast	2026
*Max Weber Fellows 20th Anniversary Conference, 2026, European University Institute	2026
EUSA European Union Studies Association, Philadelphia	2025
MPSA Midwest Political Science Association Conference, Chicago	2025
EPSA European Political Science Association Conference	2021, 2022, 2023, 2024
MOTRA Annual Conference, Wiesbaden	2024
DVPW Deutsche Vereinigung für Politikwissenschaft Konferenz, University of Göttingen	2024
COMPTExT Interdisciplinary Conference on the Computational Text Analysis, University College Dublin	2022
ECPR European Consortium for Political Research General Conference	2021
IAPSS World Congress, Paris	2018

Workshops & colloquia.....

*UCL Law and Courts Workshop, University College London	2026
Stein Rokkan Chair in Comparative Politics Colloquium, European University Institute	2025
Max Weber Presentation, European University Institute	2025
Center for Civil Society Research Colloquium, WZB Berlin Social Science Center	2022, 2023, 2024
MOTRA Analysis Workshop	2023, 2024
Contentious Politics within Civil Society Workshop, WZB Berlin Social Science Center	2024
Extremism in Germany Workshop, University of Hamburg	2023
Analyzing Protest in the Digital Age Workshop, WZB Social Science Center Berlin	2023
Cologne Political Science Workshop, Cologne	2022
Cologne-Zurich European Politics Workshop, Filzbach (CH)	2022
Cologne Center for Comparative Politics Research Seminar, University of Cologne	2020, 2021
Colloquium on Empirical Democracy Research, Goethe University Frankfurt	2018

*scheduled

Reviewer

Journal Reviewer for: *American Political Science Review* | *American Journal of Sociology* | *Computational Communication Research* | *European Journal of Political Research* | *Italian Political Science Review/Rivista Italiana di Scienza Politica* | *Journal of Elections, Public Opinion & Parties* | *Journal of European Public Policy* | *Journal of Information Technology & Politics* | *Journal of Legislative Studies* | *Journalism* | *Legislative Studies Quarterly* | *Mobilization: an International Quarterly* | *Parliamentary Affairs* | *Political Behavior* | *Social Forces* | *Social Problems* | *West European Politics*

Professional responsibilities & memberships

WZB Berlin Social Science Center

Member of Selection Committee for WZB Harvard & World Merit Fellowships 2025/26

2024

University of Cologne | Cologne Graduate School in Management, Economics & Social Sciences

PhD Representative on the Cologne Graduate School Board

2021 – 2022

Professional Memberships

- American Sociological Association (ASA)
- American Political Science Association (APSA)
- European Political Science Society (EPSS)
- Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA)
- European Union Studies Association (EUSA)
- German Political Science Association (DVPW)
- European Political Science Association (EPSA)
- Institute for the Study of Protest and Social Movements (ipb)

Other research experience

GESIS Leibniz Institute for the Social Sciences | Computational Social Science Department

Cologne (DE)

Research Intern with Sebastian Stier

2019

- Analyzed Geographic Representation on Social Media for Master's Thesis

German Federal Parliament - Bundestag | ECOFIN Committee

Berlin (DE)

Policy Intern

2019

- Preparation of Policy Positions on European Stability Mechanism

Federal Institute for Population Research | Migration and Mobility Research Group

Wiesbaden (DE)

Research Assistant with Heiko Rüger

2018 – 2019

- Development of an Online Survey for the German Ministry of Foreign Affairs

Goethe University Frankfurt | Chair for Comparative Politics

Frankfurt (DE)

Research Assistant with Thomas Zittel

2017 – 2018

- Developed a Dataset for the DFG Research Project *Individualized Representation and its Sources*

Goethe University Frankfurt | GRASOC Graduate Center Social Sciences

Frankfurt (DE)

Administrative Assistant with Prof. Sigrid Roßteutscher, PhD

2016 – 2017

- Administration of PhD Applications and Counseling Concerning Research Funding Opportunities

Max Planck Institute for the Study of Societies

Cologne (DE)

Research Intern | Research Assistant with Mark Lutter

2016

- Collected Publication Records of Social Scientists at German Universities

University of Cologne | Institute for Sociology and Social Psychology

Cologne (DE)

Teaching Assistant with Marita Jacob

2014 – 2015

- Taught *Introduction to Statistics for Social Scientists* to First Year Students

Additional skills

Languages: German (native) · English (C2) · French (B2) · Italian (A1) · Dutch (A1)

Data Analysis: R (expert) · Python (basic) · Stata (basic) · SPSS (basic)

Office & Typesetting: L^AT_EX+Overleaf · Microsoft Office · Apple iWork

Version Control: GitHub